

Step 1 - Admitted we were **powerless over alcohol**, that our lives had become **unmanageable**

Unmanageable - Unmanageability points to the disorder in our lives, whether we are actively using alcohol/chemicals or not. Write at least two examples for each of the following categories. Include your feelings about how the disease has affected your life.

- 1) **FINANCIAL PROBLEMS:** Examples may include spending money on alcohol/chemicals instead of food or rent. Having no savings, retirement plan, insurance, etc. Making poor financial decisions.
- 2) **WORK PROBLEMS:** These may include being fired, jumping from job to job, poor work performance, high absenteeism, low motivation for success, disorganized household
- 3) **PHYSICAL DETERIORATION:** Symptoms include loss of physical attractiveness, liver/health problems, nervousness, weight loss/gain, disturbed eating and/or sleeping patterns, continued use of alcohol/chemicals despite medical advise
- 4) **SPIRITUAL EMPTINESS:** There may be a conflict between your values and your behavior, spiritual longings, secret fear that God is not really there, resentment for a God that allows injustice
- 5) **FAMILY AND SOCIAL PROBLEMS:** These may include communication problems, loss of family, friends, social isolation, separation or divorce
- 6) **EMOTIONAL PROBLEMS:** These may refer to extreme anxiety, inability to express feelings unless drinking/using, difficulty in expressing anger appropriately, depression, loneliness, moodiness
- 7) **SEXUAL PROBLEMS:** May include impotence, being non-orgasmic, indifference towards sex, inappropriate sexual behavior, sexual identity conflicts
- 8) **LIFE GOAL PROBLEMS:** These may refer to education issues, frequent goal changes, frequent geographic moves, frequent relationships, marriages, divorces